

cymakers like India's own Montek Singh Ahluwalia. The group identified the common features of the growth miracles of their time, like that of China. Most of these features turned out to be the expected ones, much like the tomatoes and onions of an Indian gravy. One feature was prudent

macroeconomic policy; fiscal deficits and inflation had to be contained to keep the growth party going for long. Another feature was openness: countries with durable growth remained open to trade, technology and expertise from the rest of the world. In this regard, it is encouraging

that India has concluded several trade deals starting with Australia, the UAE, and the UK recently. There is hope for more such deals, particularly with the US, over the coming months.

The so-called Spence report also revealed a common feature of growth miracles that the chefs weren't expecting: this secret ingredient is inclusion. Countries with durable growth were more likely to be ones where growth during the miracle years included broad segments of society, instead of being confined to particular income classes, sectors, regions or gender. By this metric, India is in great shape. Growth has been associated with remarkable declines in poverty (The Economist, 2025) and no increase, if any, in income inequality. Women's participation in the economy has increased substantially. And growth has been shared across states and has included both urban and rural areas (Balasubramanian, Loun-gani and Kumar, 2021). On all these fronts, there is much room for further improvement, but it is also important to take note of, and rejoice in, the fact that India has achieved not just a growth miracle but an 'inclusive growth miracle' (Ahluwalia, 2001).

If past experience remains a reliable guide, the inclusive nature of India's growth raises the odds that it's stay in the rich countries' club will be a durable one. **BT**

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*Views are personal*

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